Country Summary: Nigeria



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Executive summary of the Nigeria country profile (2026-10-21). Superscript numbers refer to the numbered sources in Nigeria_Profile_DRAFT_SOURCES.docx.

At a Glance

237.5 m Population, 2025 estimate[2]	**9,530** GDP per capita, PPP (international dollars), about, 2025[5]	**4.19%** Current health expenditure, share of GDP, 2023[47]	**71.9%** Out-of-pocket share of current health expenditure, 2023[43]
0.38 Physicians per 1,000 people, 2023[59]	**54.6** Life expectancy at birth, years, 2024[10]	**115.6** Under-five deaths per 1,000 live births, 2024[33]	**23 m+** Health insurance enrollment, September 2026[39]

Country background

Nigeria, a federal presidential republic of 36 states and the Federal Capital Territory, Abuja, had about 237.5 million people in 2025.[1,2,6] Bola Tinubu has been president since 29 May 2023, and Muhammad Ali Pate is Coordinating Minister of Health and Social Welfare.[6,15,17,18] The federal government sets regulation, while states and local governments run general hospitals and primary health care centers.[19] Real GDP grew 4.2 percent in the first half of 2026, and inflation eased to 14.63 percent in September 2026.[6,20] The population is young, with 40.5 percent under 15, and life expectancy at birth was 54.6 years in 2024.[10,13] The key risk is affordability: an estimated 69.6 percent of Nigerians lived below $4.20 a day in 2025, and households paid most health costs.[6,43]

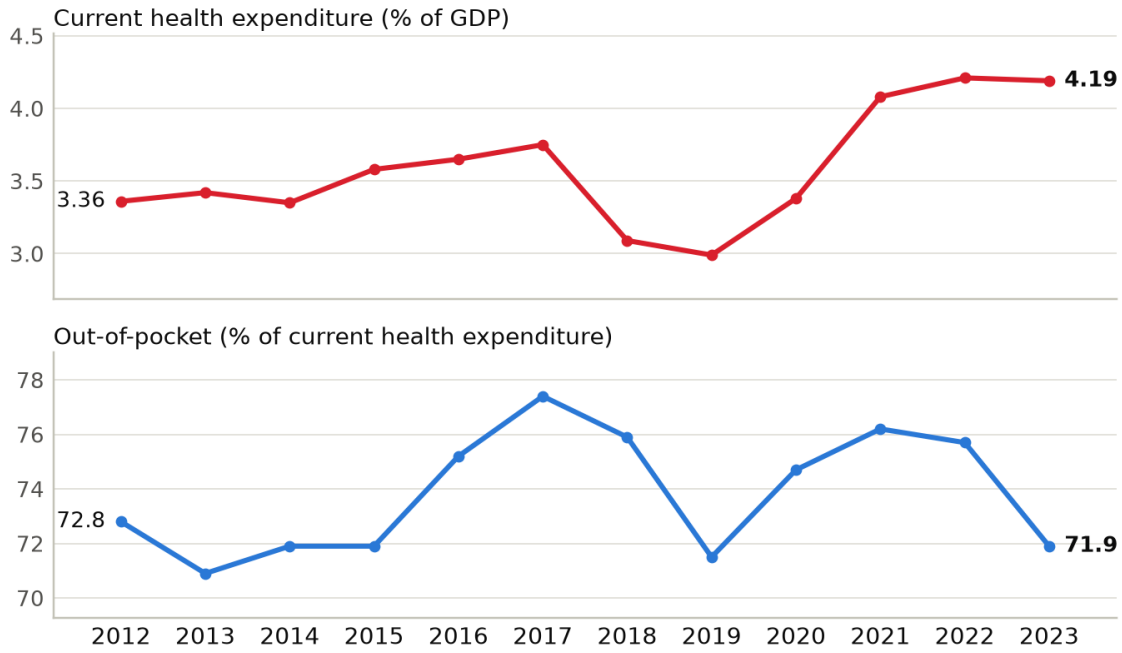
Key takeaways for CSI

- Out-of-pocket payments made up 71.9 percent of current health spending in 2023.[43]
- Practicing doctors fell 16.9 percent to about 55,000 in 2025, largely because of emigration.[60]
- Communicable, maternal, prenatal and nutritional conditions caused 63.7 percent of deaths in 2021, and noncommunicable diseases 27.7 percent.[26,27]
- Health insurance enrollment passed 23 million in September 2026, roughly 10 percent of the 2025 population.[2,39]

Health System

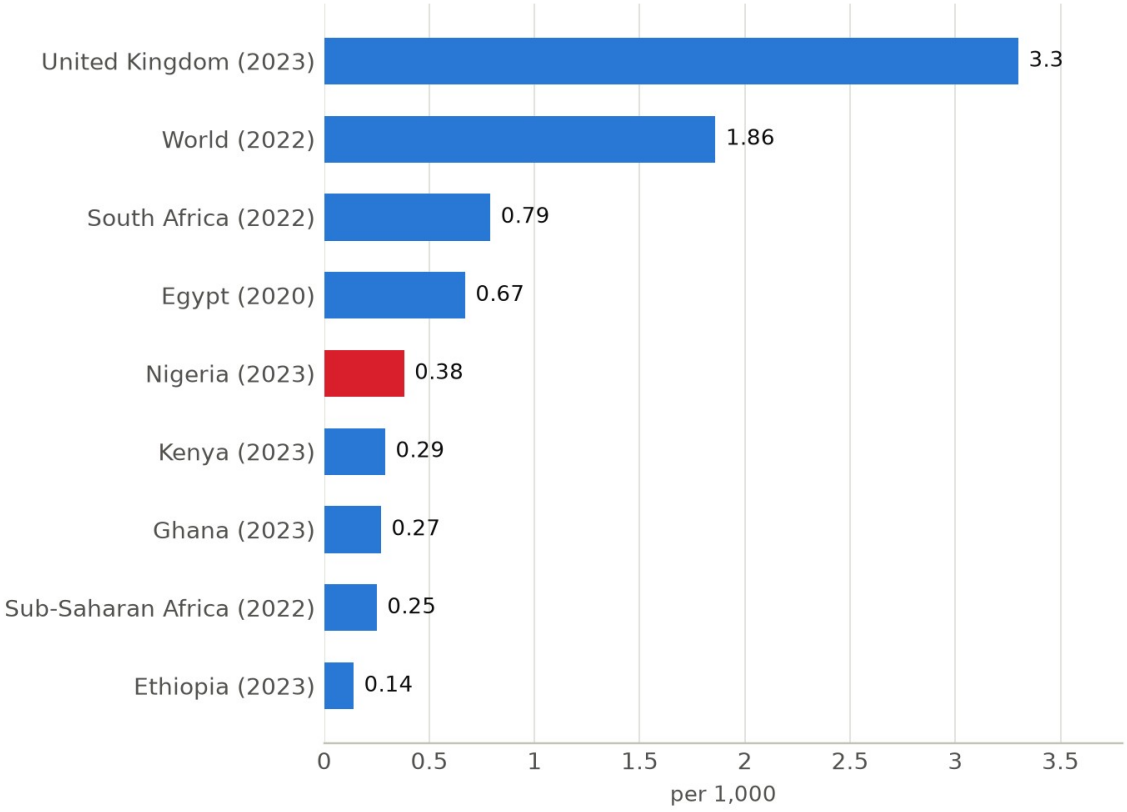
- Health spending was 4.19 percent of GDP in 2023, below Kenya, Egypt and South Africa.[47,52]
- Of 40,368 hospitals and clinics counted in mid-2021, 85.2 percent were primary and only 0.4 percent tertiary.[19]
- The United States intends to provide $2.1 billion over five years under a December 2025 health memorandum.[58]

Nigeria: health spending and out-of-pocket share, 2012 to 2023



Current health expenditure as a share of GDP, and out-of-pocket spending as a share of current health expenditure.
Sources: [93,94]

Physicians per 1,000 people, Nigeria and comparators (latest year available)

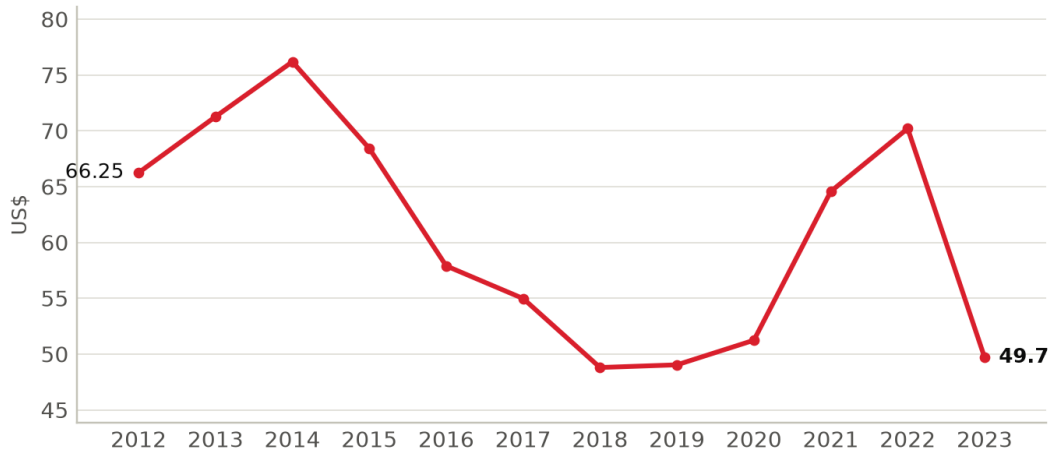


Latest year available for each country or group in the World Bank series, shown in brackets; comparison years differ (2020 to 2023). Sources: [62]

Market and Competition

- Evercare built the 165-bed Evercare Hospital Lekki in Lagos, and Padiyath Healthcare is building a 300-bed hospital in Abuja.[44,45]
- UVA Health supports the kidney transplant program at Federal Medical Centre Umuahia, one of several active U.S. academic ties.[68]
- Central Bank data show $549 million of health travel spending in the first nine months of 2025, up 18 percent.[88]

Nigeria: private health spending per person, 2012 to 2023



Domestic private health expenditure per capita in current US dollars (mostly household out-of-pocket payments); values move with the naira exchange rate. Sources: [95]

Foreign health systems active in Nigeria

19 foreign institutions with confirmed active partnerships (21 in all): 7 training and education, 7 research collaboration, 3 advisory and consulting, 3 clinical affiliation, 1 ownership or management. Sources in the profile and the partnerships tracker.



Active foreign health-system partnerships by city of the partner in Nigeria. Source: CSI partnerships tracker, verified 2026-10-21. Boundaries: Natural Earth; not an official depiction.

Institution	Nature of collaboration
Johns Hopkins University (Johns Hopkins Hospital)	Training and education
Mayo Clinic (Mayo Clinic Global Consulting)	Advisory and consulting
Memorial Sloan Kettering Cancer Center	Research collaboration
St. Jude Children's Research Hospital	Clinical affiliation

Institution	Nature of collaboration
University of Illinois Chicago (UIC School of Public Health)	Training and education
University of Maryland School of Medicine (Institute of Human Virology)	Research collaboration
University of Miami (Sylvester Comprehensive Cancer Center)	Research collaboration
University of Virginia Health System	Training and education
Vanderbilt University Medical Center (Vanderbilt Institute for Global Health)	Research collaboration
Virginia Commonwealth University (VCU Massey Comprehensive Cancer Center)	Research collaboration
Evercare Group (owned at its 2021 launch by the TPG-managed Evercare Health Fund)	Ownership or management
King's College Hospital NHS Foundation Trust	Advisory and consulting
King's College London	Training and education
Liverpool School of Tropical Medicine	Training and education
Manipal Hospitals	Training and education
The Christie NHS Foundation Trust	Advisory and consulting
The Royal Marsden NHS Foundation Trust	Clinical affiliation
University of Birmingham	Training and education
University of Glasgow	Research collaboration

CSI Position, Risks and Recent News

CSI partnerships in Nigeria

[MANUAL INPUT REQUIRED]

To be completed by CSI from internal data; not researched.

Opportunities for CSI

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To be completed by CSI from internal data; not researched.

Risks and watch items

- Presidential and National Assembly elections on 16 January 2027 could change federal priorities.[16]
- In 2024, 4,193 doctors and dentists emigrated, and 72.9 percent of surveyed medical and nursing students intended to practice abroad.[60,64]

- The 2026 budget proposal gave health N2.48 trillion (US$1.86 billion), about 4.2 percent, below the Abuja Declaration's 15 percent target.[53,54]

Recent developments

2026-02-03 The IFC and NSIA financed MedServe's $154.1 million project for diagnostic, radiotherapy and cardiac catheterization centers.[46]

2026-07-09 Health insurance enrollment reached 22.03 million, up 35 percent in a year, as mandatory provisions are phased in.[38]

2026-10-20 Nigeria confirmed an imported Ebola Bundibugyo case in Abuja, and 44 contacts are being monitored.[91,92]